

1. Establish the Business Case

Slides 1-7

1

Title Slide

Company/project name, logo, one-line value proposition, team name, and optionally one strong headline metric. Keep it visually clean.

Recommended visual/model: Strong KPI or one-line value proposition

2

Executive Summary / The Big Idea

Explain in 20-30 seconds what the business is, who it serves, what problem it solves, and why it matters. Use 3-4 headline metrics when available.

Recommended visual/model: 3-4 KPI cards

3

Problem Statement

Define the exact business/customer problem. Show who suffers from it, how frequently it happens, and how costly or painful it is.

Recommended visual/model: Bar chart, survey results, statistics, or pain-point diagram

4

Current Situation / Root Cause Analysis

Explain why the problem exists today and why current methods are insufficient.

Recommended visual/model: 5 Whys, Fishbone Diagram, current-process flow, or problem tree

5

Customer / Target Segment

Explain exactly who the customers/users are, including primary and secondary segments, behaviors, needs, and the purchasing decision maker.

Recommended visual/model: Customer Persona or Segmentation Matrix

6

Customer Journey / Pain Points

Show what the customer experiences before using the solution and where frustration, cost, delay, errors, or inefficiency occur.

Recommended visual/model: Customer Journey Map

7

Market Opportunity

Show that the problem is commercially worth solving. Include market size, growth, trends, demand, and geographic scope.

Recommended visual/model: TAM / SAM / SOM plus a market growth graph

2. Explain the Solution and Advantage

Slides 8-13

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Solution Overview

Introduce the product/service clearly. Explain what it does and how it addresses the problem without going too technical yet.

Recommended visual/model: Product mockup, workflow, system diagram, or before/after comparison

9

How the Solution Works

Explain the end-to-end user/business flow from input to result. For technical projects, show major components without overwhelming the business audience.

Recommended visual/model: Process flow, architecture diagram, or service blueprint

10

Value Proposition

Answer: Why would someone pay for this? Show measurable benefits such as cost reduction, time savings, revenue uplift, accuracy, convenience, or risk reduction.

Recommended visual/model: Value Proposition Canvas or Before vs After table

11

Unique Selling Proposition / Competitive Advantage

Explain what makes the offering difficult to replace: price, technology, experience, data, partnerships, distribution, speed, or customization.

Recommended visual/model: 3-5 competitive advantage pillars

12

Competitive Analysis

Show direct and indirect competitors and how you compare. Do not claim there are no competitors.

Recommended visual/model: Competitor Matrix, Feature Comparison Table, or 2x2 Positioning Map

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Business Model Canvas

Use a dedicated slide containing all nine blocks: Customer Segments, Value Propositions, Channels, Customer Relationships, Revenue Streams, Key Resources, Key Activities, Key Partners, and Cost Structure.

Recommended visual/model: Business Model Canvas - all 9 blocks

3. Show How the Business Wins

Slides 14-19

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Revenue Model / Monetization

Go deeper than the canvas. Explain exactly how money enters the business: subscriptions, commission, licensing, transaction fees, SaaS plans, B2B contracts, freemium, etc. Include pricing where possible.

Recommended visual/model: Pricing tiers or revenue-stream diagram

15

Go-to-Market Strategy

Explain how you will reach customers. Include acquisition channels, sales model, marketing strategy, partnerships, and launch approach.

Recommended visual/model: Go-to-Market funnel

16

Marketing & Sales Funnel

Quantify the acquisition process from awareness to paying customers and show key conversion rates.

Recommended visual/model: Funnel chart

17

Operations / Delivery Model

Explain how the business will operate after acquiring customers: suppliers, partners, people, technology, support, delivery, manufacturing, logistics, or service operations.

Recommended visual/model: Operating Model or Process Flow

18

Technology / Product Architecture

For technical startups, explain the main technical components and how they connect while keeping the business audience in mind.

Recommended visual/model: High-level system architecture

19

Validation / Prototype / Traction

Show evidence the idea works: prototype results, interviews, pilot customers, revenue, signups, model results, partnerships, or surveys.

Recommended visual/model: Traction graph, KPI cards, screenshots, or pilot-result chart

4. Prove Performance and Economics

Slides 20-26

20

Key Performance Indicators

Explain how success will be measured: revenue, conversion, CAC, retention, churn, active users, order value, satisfaction, utilization, model accuracy, or other business-critical metrics.

Recommended visual/model: KPI dashboard

21

Financial Assumptions

Explain the assumptions behind forecasts: price, customer count, growth, operating expenses, marketing spending, salaries, infrastructure costs, and other drivers.

Recommended visual/model: Assumption table / driver tree

22

Revenue Forecast

Show projected revenue over 3-5 years or quarters and explain the drivers of growth.

Recommended visual/model: Line chart or bar chart

23

Cost Structure

Show major fixed and variable costs: salaries, cloud, manufacturing, marketing, logistics, software, office, and others.

Recommended visual/model: Stacked bar or pie chart

24

Profitability / Financial Projection

Show Revenue, Costs, Gross Profit, and Net Profit. Ideally demonstrate when the business becomes profitable.

Recommended visual/model: Revenue vs Cost vs Profit graph

25

Break-Even Analysis

Show how many customers, orders, or subscriptions are needed to cover fixed and variable costs. Formula: Break-even units = Fixed Costs / (Price - Variable Cost).

Recommended visual/model: Break-even graph

26

Unit Economics

Include CAC, LTV, Gross Margin, Payback Period, and LTV:CAC Ratio. This answers whether acquiring a customer is economically worthwhile.

Recommended visual/model: Unit economics scorecard

5. Funding, Execution, Risk and Closing

Slides 27-33

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Funding / Investment Requirement

If asking for money, state how much is needed and exactly what it will be used for.

Recommended visual/model: Use-of-Funds pie or stacked bar

28

Roadmap

Show what happens next: prototype, pilot, launch, acquisition, expansion, new features, geographic growth, or other milestones.

Recommended visual/model: Timeline or Gantt-style roadmap

29

Risks & Mitigation

Identify major technical, market, competitive, regulatory, financial, operational, and scalability risks and show mitigation actions.

Recommended visual/model: Risk Matrix - Probability x Impact

30

Team & Capabilities

Explain why the team can execute. Show names, roles, relevant technical/business expertise, and responsibilities - not full CVs.

Recommended visual/model: Team capability map / role cards

31

Strategic Vision / Future Expansion

Explain where the company could go after proving the initial business: new products, segments, partnerships, markets, or regions.

Recommended visual/model: 3-stage expansion roadmap

32

The Ask / Decision Slide

Clearly state what you want from the audience: investment, partnership, pilot customer, approval, resources, incubation, mentorship, or another next step.

Recommended visual/model: Specific ask + 2-3 next-step cards

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Closing Slide

Finish with one memorable sentence reinforcing the opportunity. Include company/project name and contact details. Avoid ending with only "Thank You."

Recommended visual/model: Final value statement / memorable closing visual

The Complete Business Story

Problem -> Evidence -> Customer -> Market -> Solution -> Value -> Competition -> Business Model Canvas -> Revenue Model -> Go-to-Market -> Operations -> Validation -> Financials -> Risks -> Roadmap -> Team -> Ask

Recommended 15-18 slide version for a competition or capstone

- Compress the 33-slide master flow into 15-18 slides when presentation time is limited.
- Keep the strongest evidence and models: TAM/SAM/SOM, Customer Persona, Value Proposition, Competitive Matrix, Business Model Canvas, Sales Funnel, Financial Model, Unit Economics, Risk Matrix, and Roadmap.
- Aim for roughly 5-7 data charts, 3-5 models/diagrams, several KPI cards, and minimal paragraph text.

A strong business deck does not merely describe the idea - it proves the opportunity, explains the business engine, and makes the next decision obvious.